Rongxuan Zhu

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EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy in Geography Aug 2026 - Present
University at Buffalo, The State University of New York
Master of Geographic Information Science Sep 2020 - May 2022
University of Minnesota Twin Cities
Bachelor of Arts in Earth Sciences, Minor in Computer Science Aug 2016 - Aug 2020
University of Minnesota Twin Cities

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Institute of Urban Environment, Chinese Academy of Sciences, China Aug 2022 - Jun 2026

- Analyzed urbanization patterns in Ulaanbaatar and their impacts on pastoral systems, contributing to journal manuscripts and conference presentations.
- Coordinated research projects and external collaborations, including grant proposal preparation and data sharing.

Teaching Assistant, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities, MN, U.S. Aug 2021 - May 2022

- Supported instruction and grading for introductory and advanced GIS courses.
- Led weekly lab sessions and held office hours to assist students with GIS software, spatial analysis, and coursework.

Graduate Research Assistant, University of Minnesota, Twin Cities, MN, U.S. Aug 2021 - May 2022

- Analyzed nationally representative datasets to assess the capacity of the U.S. long-term care workforce to support people with Alzheimer's disease and related dementias (AD/ADRD).
- Quantified workforce-to-AD/ADRD population ratios across urban and rural areas to identify workforce shortages; contributed to a peer-reviewed publication.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Zhu, R.**, Cui, S., Balt, S., Batzorig, E., Bold, A., Huang, Y., & Tsog, T. Coordination, Balance, and Spatial Alignment in Ulaanbaatar's Urban-Pastoral Systems. Under review at *Land Use Policy*.
- Zhong, Y., Cui, S., Bai, X., Shang, W., Huang, W., Liu, L., Wang, S., **Zhu, R.,** Zhai, Y., & Zhang, Y. (2024). Carbon emissions from urban takeaway delivery in China. *npj Urban Sustainability* 4, 39. https://doi.org/10.1038/s42949-024-00175-8
- Dill, J., Henning-Smith, C., **Zhu, R.,** & Vomacka, E. (2023). Who Will Care for Rural Older Adults? Measuring the Direct Care Workforce in Rural Areas. *Journal of Applied Gerontology*, 42(8), 1800–1808. https://doi.org/10.1177/07334648231158482

PRESENTATIONS

- **Zhu, R.** Multi-Dimensional Evaluation of the Urbanization Impact on Ulaanbaatar City. Mongolian Academy of Sciences, Ulaanbaatar, Jun 2024.
- **Zhu, R.** Spatial Segregation in the Twin Cities. CTS Transportation Research Conference, Minnesota (Online), Nov 2021.
- **Zhu, R.** Structural Racism & Cardiometabolic Risk. Summer Diversity Fellowship, Minnesota (Online), Aug 2021.

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Summer Diversity Fellowship, University of Minnesota (2021)
- Dean's List, University of Minnesota (2020)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GIS Software: ArcGIS, QGIS

Spatial databases: PostgreSQL, PostGIS, SQL

Programming: Python, R, HTML, JavaScript